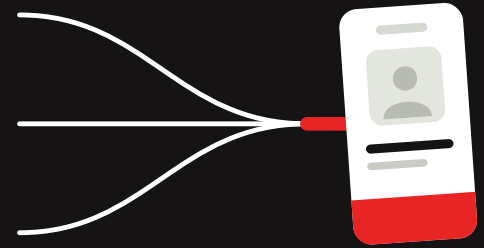


Student free tools, checked.

23 tools checked against official pages on 3 October 2026. Every one has an honest label, and every link goes to the provider's own page.



How to read the labels

 Student-free	Free while you are a verified student. Most of these renew each year.
 Via college	Free only if your college has signed up. Ask your library or T&P cell.
 Discount	Cheaper for students, but you still pay.
 Always free	Free for everyone. No student proof needed.
 Paused or ended	Was free once. Check before you plan around it.

Claim in this order

- 1 GitHub Student Pack**
Verify first. JetBrains accepts it as proof too.
- 2 College-email tools**
Azure, Notion, Microsoft 365, Altium and MATLAB.
- 3 SheerID tools**
Google AI Plus before 31 December, and Figma Education.
- 4 Set reminders**
Renewals fall at 12 months. Google AI Plus bills after year one.

Before you apply

College email

The fastest route. Microsoft 365, Notion, Altium and MATLAB check your email domain first.

No college email? Use dated proof.

An ID card with an expiry date, a fee or registration receipt, a class schedule, a transcript, or an enrollment (bonafide) letter. It must show your name, your college and a current date.

These usually fail

Undated ID cards, email screenshots, and admission letters for a future term. They do not prove current enrollment.

For GitHub

Allow location, turn off VPN, and apply from campus or on mobile data. A logo alone does not prove the college name.

How this was checked

Each entry is based on the provider's own page or help centre as of 3 October 2026. Where an entry relies on press or tracker coverage instead, it says so: Google AI Plus terms in India, the AWS Student Rewards launch details, and the Perplexity, Cursor and ChatGPT status lines.

Offers, prices and country rules change often. A college ID card alone does not guarantee access, so confirm on the provider's page before you plan around an offer.

Spotted a change?

Email technicaltriveni@gmail.com and the list gets updated. Follow @TechnicalTriveni on Instagram and Technical Triveni on YouTube for builds, tools and the next check. Use student licenses for learning: several of them (JetBrains, Autodesk, Altium) forbid commercial work.

Code and cloud

Developer tools and cloud credit for verified students.

Tool and official page	Status	What you get	What you need, and the catch
GitHub Student Developer Pack education.github.com/pack	🟢 Student-free	GitHub Pro features, Codespaces and dozens of partner offers while you stay verified. Benefits usually activate within about 72 hours of approval.	Needs a school email on your GitHub account, or a dated ID, transcript, enrollment letter or class schedule showing your name and college. Allow location access and turn off any VPN. In March 2026 students moved to a smaller Copilot Student plan, and GitHub's FAQ says new Copilot Student activations are paused.
JetBrains Student License jetbrains.com/community/education	🟢 Student-free	Free educational license for the JetBrains desktop IDEs, including IntelliJ IDEA Ultimate, PyCharm, WebStorm and CLion.	Non-commercial learning use only. Renew each year while you study. You can apply with a college email, an ISIC or ITIC card, a GitHub Student Developer Pack account, or a copy of your student ID.
Azure for Students azure.microsoft.com/free/students	🟢 Student-free	USD 100 of Azure credit valid for 12 months, plus free services. No credit card at sign-up.	One Azure for Students subscription per person. The credit cannot be used for Azure Marketplace offers. After 12 months you can sign up again while you are still a student.
AWS Student Rewards builder.aws.com	🟢 Student-free	Twelve months of premium AWS Skill Builder, plus AWS credits and a certification exam voucher that you unlock by earning Builder badges.	Launched 20 August 2026 on AWS Builder Center. As reported at launch: USD 10 in credits at 7 badges, another USD 20 at 14 badges, and a USD 100 exam voucher at 21. Confirm country eligibility on the page.

AI and productivity

Assistants, docs and notes.

Tool and official page	Status	What you get	What you need, and the catch
Google AI Plus (Gemini for Students) gemini.google/students	🟢 Student-free	One year of Google AI Plus at no cost for eligible college students in India. Students in the US get Google AI Pro instead.	Redeem by 31 December 2026. Verification runs through SheerID and you must be 18 or older. You may be asked for a payment method, and it renews at the paid price after the free year unless you cancel, so set a reminder. India terms are as reported by press in September 2026; confirm on the page.
Microsoft 365 Education microsoft.com/education/products/office	🟢 Via college	Web versions of Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneNote and Teams with 1 TB of OneDrive. Desktop apps depend on what your school licenses.	Works only if your school takes part and your email domain is recognised. If sign-up says you are not eligible, ask your college IT desk.
Notion Education Plus notion.com/product/notion-for-education	🟢 Student-free	A free Plus plan for individual students and educators on a one-member workspace.	Your account must use a school email that Notion recognises. In Settings choose Upgrade plan, then Get free Education plan. If the option is missing, ask Notion support to add your college domain.

Design and video

For projects, portfolios and your channel.

Tool and official page	Status	What you get	What you need, and the catch
Figma Education figma.com/education	🟢 Student-free	Free Professional-plan features (Figma Design, FigJam, Slides, Dev Mode) for verified higher-education students.	It is a team plan: create or upgrade a team to the Education plan after approval. Changing your account email revokes the status. Re-verify when it expires. Colleges that issue no email make the verification step harder, so keep a dated school document ready.
Canva for Education canva.com/education	🟡 Via college	Canva for Education is free for K-12 teachers and students. College and university students are not eligible on their own.	If your college has signed up for Canva for Campus you can get institution-managed premium access. Otherwise use Canva Free or pay for Pro.
Adobe Creative Cloud adobe.com/in/creativecloud/buy/students	🟡 Discount	Student and teacher pricing on Creative Cloud Pro. Adobe India lists ₹638.38 a month including GST for the first year (annual plan, billed monthly), then ₹1,516.30 a month.	This is about 70 percent off, not a free plan. Adobe lists a 7-day free trial. Prices change often, so confirm on the page before you pay.
DaVinci Resolve (free version) blackmagicdesign.com/products/davinciresolve	🟢 Always free	The free version has no watermark and no time limit, and includes editing, colour grading, Fusion effects and Fairlight audio.	Output is capped at UHD 3840x2160 and the Studio-only AI tools are missing. Studio is a one-time purchase of about USD 295.

Learning and career

Courses and certificates from known names.

Tool and official page	Status	What you get	What you need, and the catch
NPTEL on SWAYAM npTEL.ac.in	🟢 Always free	Free enrolment in courses from the IITs and IISc through the SWAYAM portal. Two semesters a year, January and July.	Only the proctored certification exam carries a fee, roughly ₹500 to ₹1,000 depending on the course, with waivers for some categories. Use one email for every enrolment and exam registration.
Cisco Networking Academy netacad.com	🟢 Always free	Free self-paced online courses in networking, cybersecurity and programming on NetAcad.	NetAcad states that self-paced classes are free. Instructor-led classes are priced by the school or institution that runs them. Check each course page for certificate and exam terms.
Coursera for Campus coursera.org	🟡 Via college	Free access to a course catalogue and certificates when your institution runs a Coursera for Campus programme.	Varies by college, and some colleges cap how many courses you can take at once. Ask your library, T&P cell or training department. Without a college programme you will see Coursera's normal paid plans.
LinkedIn Learning linkedin.com/learning	🟡 Via college	Courses from industry experts when your institution or library provides access.	Without institutional access only a trial and paid plans apply.

ECE, VLSI and embedded

Circuits, PCB, FPGA and simulation.

Tool and official page	Status	What you get	What you need, and the catch
Autodesk Education (Fusion, AutoCAD) autodesk.com/in/education	🟢 Student-free	Free one-year, single-user access to Autodesk software for educational use, renewable each year while you are eligible. The list includes Fusion, AutoCAD and AutoCAD Electrical.	Open to post-secondary students aged 18 or older at qualified institutions. Educational use only.
MATLAB and Simulink mathworks.com/academia/students	🟢 Via college	A Campus-Wide License gives a college's students MATLAB and Simulink on any device. MATLAB Onramp is a free two-hour tutorial.	Create a MathWorks account with your college email to see whether your college has a license. Without one, MATLAB Online (basic) is free for 20 hours a month with a smaller product set.
Altium Designer student license altium.com/education/students	🟢 Student-free	A free academic license of the current Altium Designer through the Altium Education programme, renewable while you are a student.	Applications can take a day or two. Domains that do not end in .edu may not be approved automatically, in which case contact Altium support. Personal, educational use only.
AMD Vivado ML Standard xilinx.com/support/download	🟢 Always free	Free edition of AMD's FPGA design suite, enough for smaller devices such as some Artix-7 boards.	Needs a free AMD account. The download is large, and bigger devices need a paid license.
Quartus Prime Lite (Altera) altera.com	🟢 Always free	Free download with no license file required, aimed at Intel's high-volume FPGA device families.	Needs a free account to download. The newest device families need the paid Standard or Pro editions.
Wokwi wokwi.com	🟢 Always free	Browser simulator for Arduino, ESP32 and Raspberry Pi Pico. The free plan has unlimited simulations and virtual WiFi.	Free-plan projects are public. Private projects and custom libraries need a paid plan, from about USD 7 a month.
LTspice analog.com/ltspice	🟢 Always free	Free SPICE simulator, schematic capture and waveform viewer from Analog Devices.	Builds are available for Windows and macOS.
KiCad kicad.org	🟢 Always free	Open-source schematic capture and PCB design suite.	Licensed under the GNU GPL and runs on Windows, Linux and macOS. A good first step before a paid PCB tool.

Checked and not free

Claims that circulate often. Labels marked "reported" come from press or tracker pages, so confirm on the provider's page.

GitHub Copilot Pro for students Paused	Students moved to a smaller Copilot Student plan in March 2026. GitHub's FAQ says new activations are paused, with no end date given.	GitHub Education FAQ
Google AI Pro offer for India (2025) Ended	The original India sign-up closed in September 2025. The current India offer is Google AI Plus.	gemini.google/students
Canva Pro for college students Not individual	Canva for Education covers K-12. College students get Pro only through a Canva for Campus deal.	canva.com/education
Adobe Creative Cloud Discount	Student pricing is about 70 percent off, not free.	adobe.com/in/creativecloud/buy/students
CapCut Pro No universal plan	No standing student Pro plan found. Some partner universities in CapCut's Creative Campus programme are reported to get Pro.	capcut.com/education
Perplexity Education Pro Reported changed	Reported September 2026: the free year has closed and a discounted student plan remains. Confirm the price on the page.	perplexity.ai
Cursor Pro student year Reported ended	Two September 2026 trackers report the free student year has ended. Confirm on the page.	cursor.com/students
ChatGPT Plus student offer Reported US-only	Reported September 2026 as limited to US students. Check regional offers on the page.	chatgpt.com

Common problems and fixes

School not found or not eligible

Type the college name exactly as printed on your document. If the dropdown has no match, ask your IT desk whether a student email domain exists.

My college gives no email

Use a dated school document. GitHub and SheerID-based offers accept these. Microsoft 365, Notion, MATLAB and Altium rely on your email domain, so ask your college for one.

Document rejected

Show your name, the college name and a current date in one sharp photo. A logo alone is not enough. Undated ID cards, email screenshots and future-term admission letters usually fail.

GitHub location or camera error

Turn off your VPN, allow location in the browser, and try from a phone on mobile data. Take a live photo instead of uploading an old one.

Verification limit exceeded

Stop retrying. Fix the document first, then contact the provider's support instead of submitting the same file again.

Renewals to put in your calendar

Azure for Students 12 months

Sign up again while still a student.

Google AI Plus 12 months

Cancel before the free year ends, or it bills you.

AWS Skill Builder Premium 12 months

Use the badges and voucher inside the year.

JetBrains 1 year

Use the renewal link in your JetBrains account.

Autodesk Education 1 year

Renew from your Autodesk account while eligible.

Figma Education Until it expires

Re-verify when Figma asks.

Altium Designer Until it expires

Re-apply through Altium Education.

GitHub Student Pack About 2 years

Re-verification is requested at the end.